

ANIME

Haikyu!!

★★★★★ | We wouldn't call ourselves frequent watchers of sports anime. There are quite a few notable ones out there, Kuroko no Basket, Prince of Tennis, Diamond no Ace, to name a few, but for the most part, we think a lot of people forgo watching sports anime for various reasons. Not being interested in the sport the anime is about for one, or simply preferring to watch the real sport rather than an animated version. Personally, we've only ever watched Captain Tsubasa from back in the day, and Hungry Heart, both of which were football anime. We definitely enjoyed watching them but we still wouldn't actively go out seeking sports anime. Haiku!! is an anime that's been on our radar for a while. Out of curiosity, we decided to give it a watch, to find out what it is everyone was raving about.



The raving was definitely justified, because in Haikyu!! we found one of the best sports anime, heck, best anime in general we've seen in a long time, period. We never thought we'd see the day where we'd be so hyped

for an anime, about volleyball of all things, but Haikyu!! manages it with ease. The storytelling, the characters, the animation, the suspense of it all, Haikyu!! executes it perfectly. While it starts off a bit slow, the show has good pacing, and, like any Shounen anime, be prepared for plenty of cliffhangers at the end of episodes. The anime spends a good deal of time and investment into all characters, and not just the supposed main characters of the show. This is something we haven't seen a lot of in anime. This time that you invest watching the show and watching the supporting characters grow at no point feels wasted, and you're only rewarded later when you see the results of their endeavours. They're more than just side-characters in this show. Emotions run high in Haikyu!!, and it's infectious, you start feeling what the characters are feeling and it's an experience that can't really be explained. This is definitely an anime you should give a watch to, even if you're not into sports anime.

BOOK

Fowl Twins

★★★★☆ | After the Artemis Fowl series of books, Eoin Colfer has upped his game with the Fowl Twins, and Deny All Charges is at least as brilliant, mischievous and hilarious as Jonathan Stroud's Bartimaeus Sequence. This is urban fantasy at its finest, with technology and magic blending together in novel ways because the rules of the game have changed. Fairies now have a lot of the restrictions on them removed, and move about more freely, but just as discreetly on the surface. The technology has advanced with the generations, and now the twin protagonists Myles and Beckett Fowl are just like the rest of us, adding fuel to the fire in internet discussions, or using FaceTime to talk with their fairy patrol



officer. All the tech makes sense, which is what makes it really on the harder side of science fiction, even though there are literally trolls, fairies, dwarfs and centaurs flying around.

Add to that, the series is peppered with some really smart physics jokes! There is a scientific approach for every situation, and say after a troll attack, the venom will be analysed in a lab, so even the magic is a precise science. In universe events inspired by real world cyber attacks are part of the backstory, so this book is packed with pop culture easter eggs, but at the same time these are really easter eggs and not references shoved down your throat by the dozen the way Ready Player One does. There are a bunch of old favorites from the original Artemis Fowl series, but even readers who have not read them can easily start with the new series. It does not matter which of the two you read first really. The Fowl Twins come up very briefly in the Artemis Fowl series, but you get a good idea of what you can expect from them if you have read the books. Fowl Twins is the first book, and the second one is Deny All Charges.